



Planning

Given a customer scenario, analyze and recommend the appropriate governance framework.

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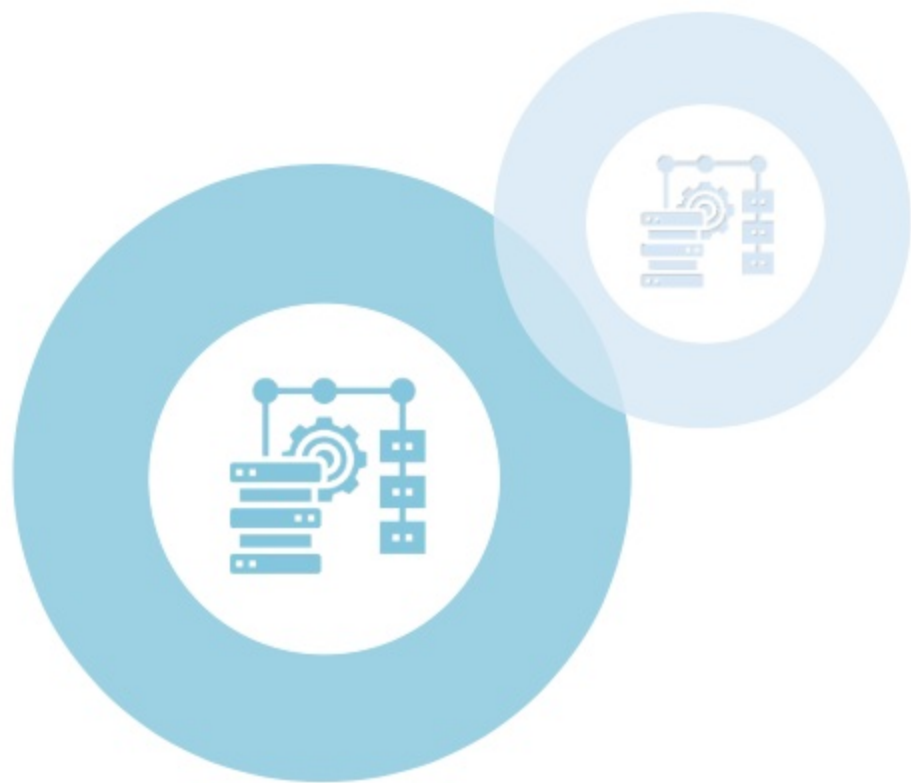
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After studying this topic, you should be able to:

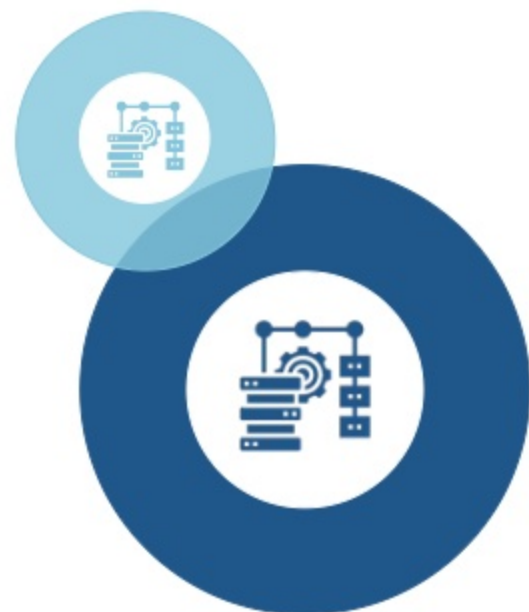
-  Define governance and identify its importance and key components.
-  Describe how to develop a governance framework and identify the related considerations.
-  Describe the functions of a Center of Excellence (CoE) and explain how to build it.
-  Define change management and describe how to implement an effective change management process.



Introduction

A robust **governance framework** in Salesforce is crucial for aligning projects with business objectives and ensuring effective management. This framework should involve **clear rules, processes, and responsibilities**, guided by a **Center of Excellence (CoE)**.

The CoE coordinates **strategic planning** and **project execution**, ensuring adherence to **standards**. It harmonizes efforts across various teams, ensuring everyone works towards a common goal and adheres to the established standards. Additionally, effective **change management** is an integral part of a governance framework since it facilitates smooth transitions and adoption of new processes and technologies.



Governance

Governance

Governance refers to the minimal processes needed for a program to deliver business outcomes with the required quality and within the business timeframe.

Center Of Excellence

Center of Excellence (CoE) is a group of cross-functional experts responsible for setting best practices, governance, and standards across the organization.



Governance Framework

The components of a governance program fall into four major categories, namely, Center of Excellence (CoE), Change Management, Org Strategy, and Technical Governance.

Change Management

Change Management is the process used to identify, prioritize, assign, execute and communicate changes. The Change Control Board reviews and approves change requests.

Governance

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What is Governance?

Governance is the **minimal set of processes** needed for a program to deliver **business outcomes** with the **quality** required and within the **business timeframe**.

❖ UNIQUE

Governance is the result of an accumulation of **decisions, actions, and planning** that are **unique** to the team, department, and organization.

❖ FOCUS

It helps the program team **focus on the business backlog** while **adhering to IT policies and best practices**.

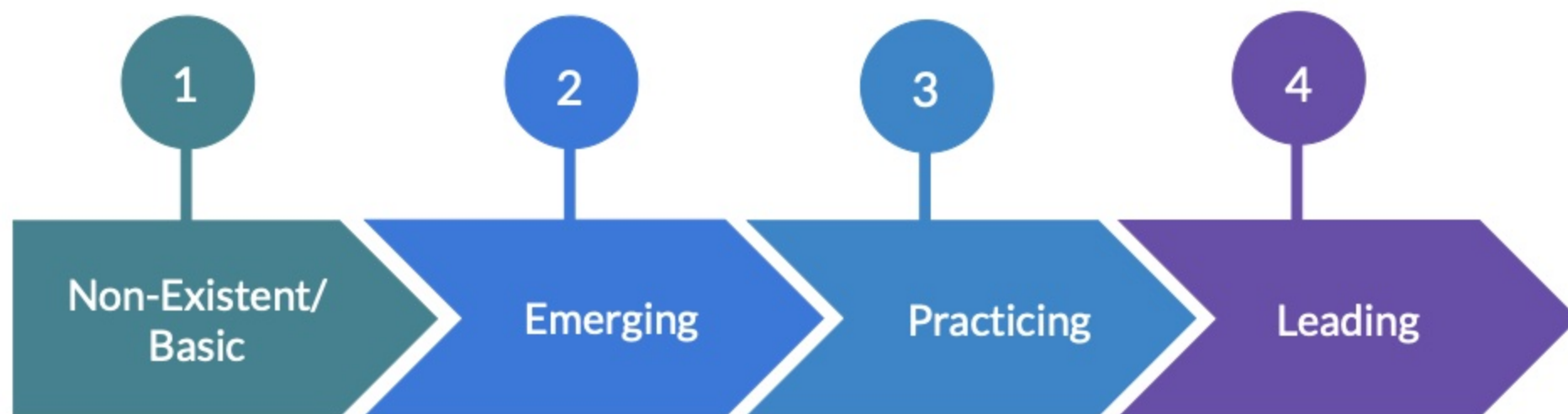
❖ PARTNERSHIP

In a **comprehensive governance framework**, **business** and **IT** work together to build and manage mission critical **Salesforce solutions**.



Governance Stages Of Maturity

The **desired maturity level** should be considered when developing a **governance framework**. There are **four stages of maturity**.



Importance of Governance

Governance enables **innovation**, **compliance**, **velocity**, **delivery**, and **reduced risk**.



Governance allows business areas to **innovate** at their own pace through adoption of agile and new features and functionality.



Governance ensures proper data security, visibility, and access in a new solution to meet the **compliance requirements**.



Governance ensures the consistency of prioritization and application roadmap development to drive **business velocity**.



Governance improves the **quality of the deliverable** through the documentation of best practices for the organization.



Governance **reduces business risks** by delivering what the business requires and when it requires it.

Benefits and Pitfalls

There are various **benefits and pitfalls** associated with governance.



BENEFITS

A **good governance framework** drives business value, reduces and manages risk, enables improved agility, innovation, and compliance, and ensures timely delivery.



PITFALLS

A **poor governance framework** causes a lack of alignment between business and IT, low solution adoption, increased costs, reduced value, increased program risk, and slow delivery of capabilities.

Governance Subdomains

There are several **key subdomains** that help **create governance**.

VISION & STRATEGY

A clear vision and strategy are defined, including business objectives, steps to achieve them, and metrics to measure progress.

PRINCIPLES

Using the principles of software engineering, a clear development, testing, and QA process is created for all teams.

BUSINESS BACKLOG

Users who will own and prioritize the requirements backlog and what they will consider are defined.

COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

A communication strategy is defined to ensure governance alignment across all stakeholders.

DATA ARCHITECTURE

A business-data model is created, and the source of truth, where all data is collected and managed, is determined.

STAKEHOLDER MANAGEMENT

All stakeholders who should help determine or understand the governance framework are defined.

Governance Framework

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Developing a Governance Framework

The following **steps** are followed to **create a governance framework**:

1	The delivery challenges for the program are documented .
2	The maturity in the core framework processes is understood.
3	A clear vision and strategy are defined, followed by engaging stakeholders and gaining their alignment.
4	The business must own and prioritize its requirements.
5	The current approach to data architecture and management is reviewed.

Developing a Governance Framework

The following **steps** are followed to **create a governance framework**:

6	The basic principles of software engineering are implemented.
7	Foundational processes are implemented.
8	All projects within the program should follow the defined processes .
9	Additional processes based on challenges are considered.
10	Processes are constantly reviewed for improvements in their maturity.

Governance Categories

The components of a **governance program** fall into four major categories.



Center of Excellence

Center of Excellence (CoE) is a group of cross-functional experts responsible for **setting best practices, governance, and standards** across the organization.



Change Management

Change Management is the process of **managing change** within the overall program or project lifecycle, from collecting requirements through go-live in production.



Org Strategy

Org strategy refers to the **design and structure** of the foundational orgs that contain Salesforce applications.



Technical Governance

Technical governance covers the **guiding principles** used to develop the **technical aspects** of Salesforce.

Governance Requirements

Governance ensures that the **organization and Center of Excellence are aligned** for the success of Salesforce implementations.

CLEAR GOAL

Governance requires a **clear goal or vision** for the organization and the use of Salesforce, which can be referred to throughout the decision-making process.



KEY ASPECTS

Governance involves assembling the **right team**, defining **vision and strategies**, and implementing the **best practices** for managing a Salesforce instance.

Governance Team

The success of a governance process relies on **assembling the right team**.

The size of the governance team can vary from a **small group of a few individuals to a team of up to 10 members**, depending on the organization's size and needs.



Key stakeholders, like the Executive Director, CEO, Directors of Business Units, technical staff, business owners, and end users, should be included in the Center of Excellence.



Inclusivity is crucial; the aim should be to build a **diverse** team. The **Salesforce Administrator** is an essential team member responsible for implementing governance decisions.



Design Standards

Clear and compatible design standards associated with the vision can be defined.



Clear naming conventions should be defined. For example, all custom objects, fields, and classes can be appended with a 3-digit code of the business unit that made the request.



Use of the **description fields** should be **clearly defined**. For example, all description fields must contain the name of the business unit that requested it and contain links to dependencies.



Custom Apex classes and triggers should be **annotated with plain English explanations** of logic and explanations. For example, a trigger can include what it does when a certain action occurs.



Design documentation should use a **standard template** and include at least **one image**. It should be **easily accessible**, and **regular audits** must be performed to ensure compliance.

Release and Deployment Strategy

An **internal release strategy** should ensure that releases are compatible with new core features. A **deployment strategy** defines how to create, test, and deploy changes.



A **consistent release strategy** allows communicating with users **promptly and effectively** and ensures that sandboxes are **created or refreshed in time** for pre-release versions.



Consistent internal releases **build trust and foster the adoption** of Salesforce. Release communication should include an area that **thanks users who contributed ideas for enhancements**.



Changes should be **developed and tested in a sandbox** and **deployed safely**. A typical deployment lifecycle consists of stages such as development, QA, UAT, staging, and production.

Backlog Prioritization

In larger organizations, the **Center of Excellence** should meet regularly to **prioritize the backlog** of enhancements and feature requests.



STRATEGY

The group's **understanding of each business unit and the organizational vision** guides the strategic sequencing of projects.



REQUESTS

The use of **transparent systems** like **Jira, Confluence, or Slack** is suggested for managing requests and fostering user engagement.



ALIGNMENT

Publicizing decision-making processes and **project timelines** helps align end-users with the organization's vision and set clear expectations.

Center Of Excellence

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Need for Center of Excellence

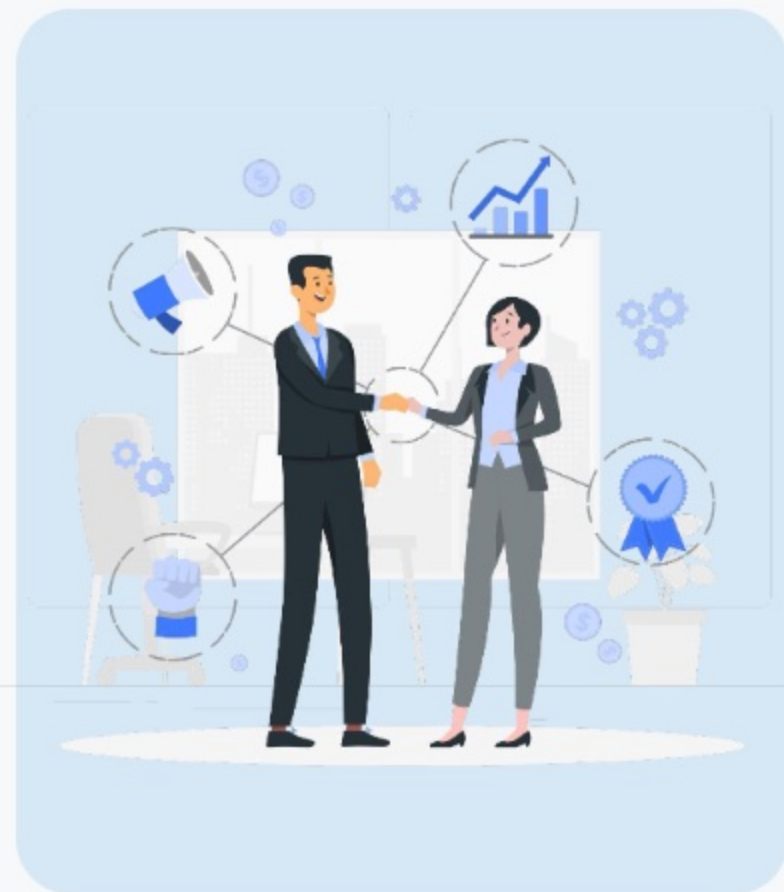
The need for a **Center of Excellence (CoE)** is driven by many factors, including the **size, ambition, and Salesforce footprint**.

❖ IMPLEMENTATION

Center of Excellence (CoE) ensures that a Salesforce implementation is **agile, running efficiently**, and **meets the needs of the staff**.

❖ CHALLENGES

CoE can help deal with challenges such as **running over budget, issues convincing users to adopt new functions, challenges working with multiple partners, falling behind schedule** due to lack of decision-making, etc.



Need for Center of Excellence

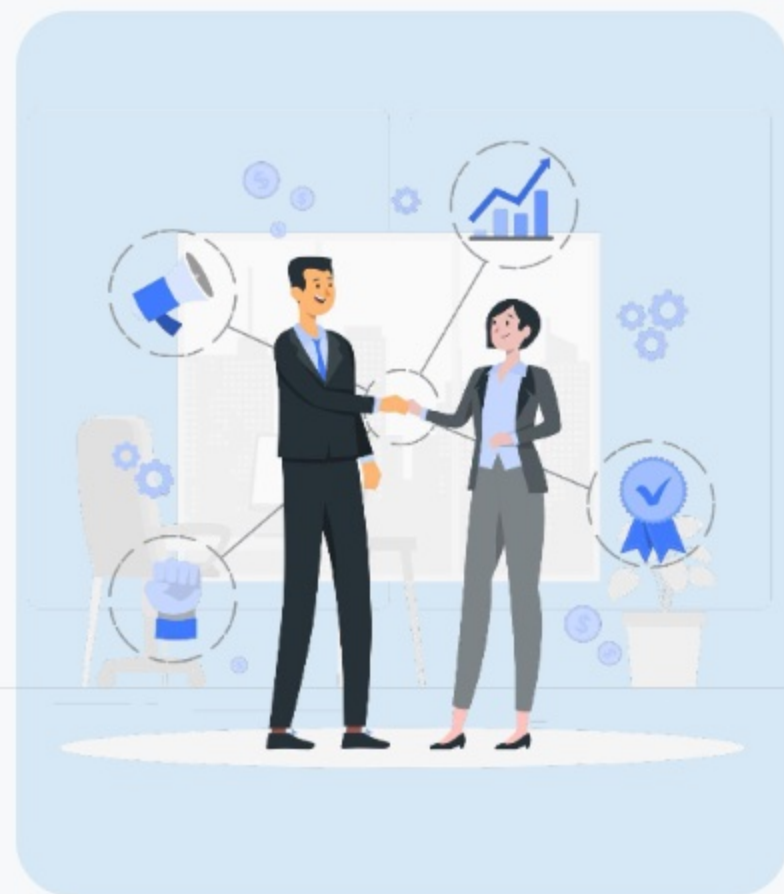
The need for a **Center of Excellence (CoE)** is driven by many factors, including the **size, ambition, and Salesforce footprint**.

❖ VISION

The need for CoE should be driven by the organization's **vision**. The vision directly impacts **how a Salesforce instance is used** and its **success**. It can be used only as a CRM or for all the features and functions required by an organization.

❖ BALANCE

It ensures that the **divergent and convergent views and requirements** are balanced against the **available timelines and resources**.



Need for Center of Excellence

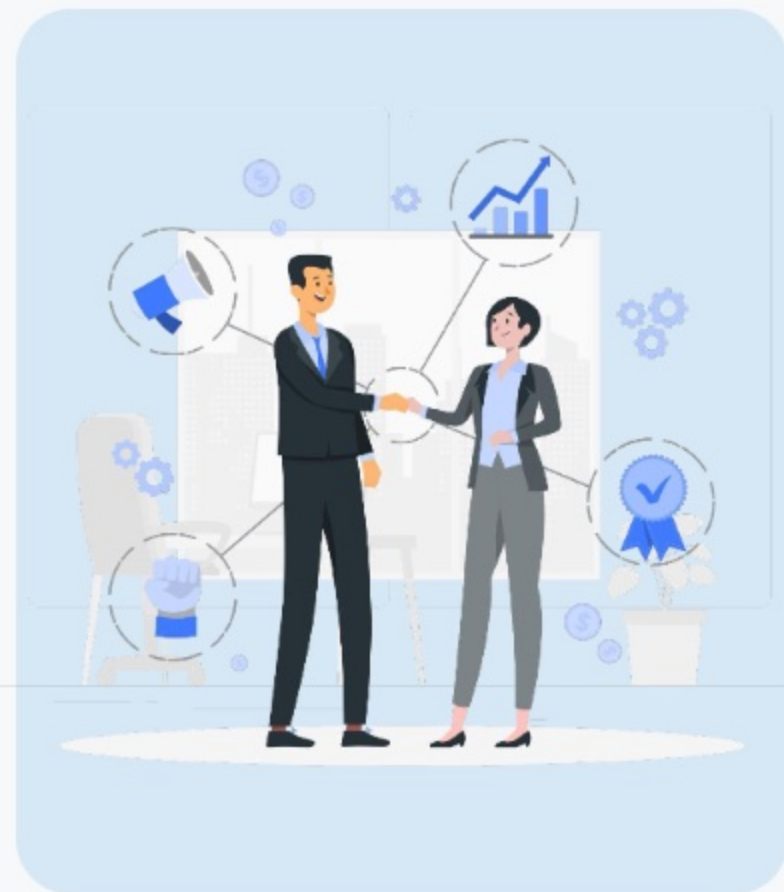
The need for a **Center of Excellence (CoE)** is driven by many factors, including the **size, ambition, and Salesforce footprint**.

❖ PROCESSES

A CoE **streamlines organizational processes**, selecting **best practices** from across multiple groups and **removing inefficiencies** and **methods** that have become **outdated**.

❖ GROWTH & RISK

Business and technology experts on the CoE can help **examine the impact of growth** and **ensure readiness** to expand Salesforce usage. A CoE also ensures that the **decisions** made are the **least risky possible**. It **balances** a wide range of **opinions and approaches** and **mitigates the loss of subject matter experts**.



Center of Excellence Models

One of three **CoE models** or a hybrid can be utilized for a Center of Excellence.



CONSOLIDATED

Teams work in a single platform with **a shared approach to data, constituents, and requirements** for a unified CRM experience.



FEDERATED

A federated model allows for **independent group operation** while **maintaining a unified approach** to CRM data.



CONFEDERATED

In a confederated model, **each group may operate independently**, potentially using **separate Salesforce instances**.

Building a Center of Excellence

Various aspects need to be considered for building a **Center of Excellence (CoE)**.

❖ PEOPLE & ROLES

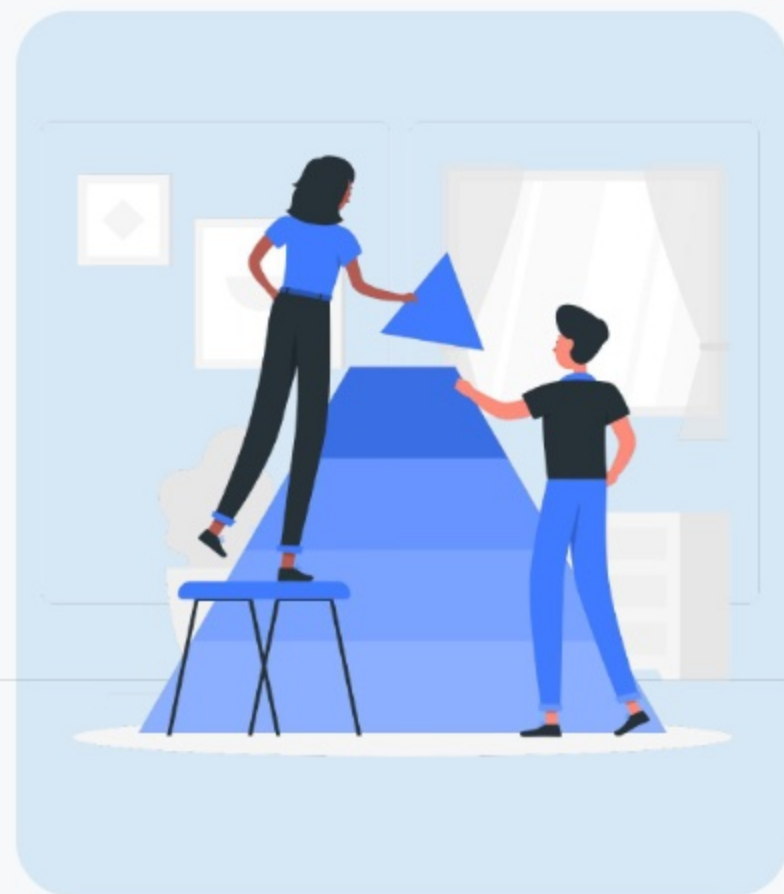
A Center of Excellence (CoE) is made of **people**. **Salesforce users** engage with the CoE. A **select subset** of these users engage with **defined roles**.

❖ CHARTER

A CoE is guided by a **charter** and **manifests in meetings**.

❖ OUTPUT

A CoE provides **output** in the form of **critical decisions** and **other deliverables**.



People & Roles

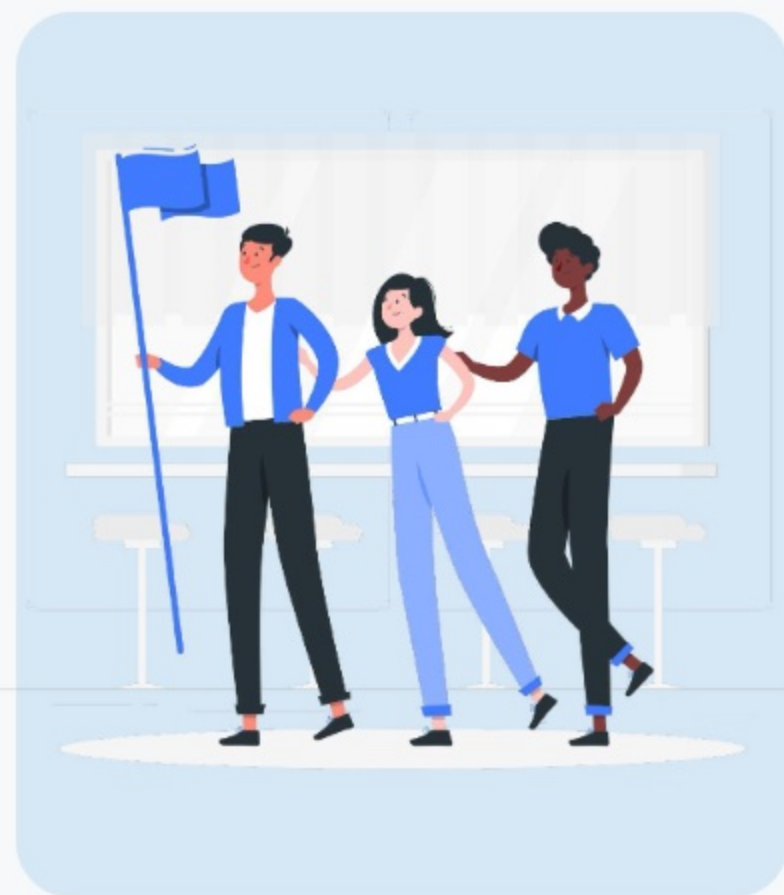
A Center of Excellence (CoE) involves various **roles**, each critical to its success. **Selecting the right individuals** for these roles is crucial.

◆ MAIN ROLES

Roles include **Executive Sponsors**, **Program Owners**, and various **Steering Committees** focusing on Business, Architecture, Release Management, Change Management, and Support.

◆ RESPONSIBILITIES

Each role has specific responsibilities, like defining organizational **strategies**, managing **program execution**, ensuring compliance with **architectural standards**, overseeing **release processes**, and leading **change management** initiatives.

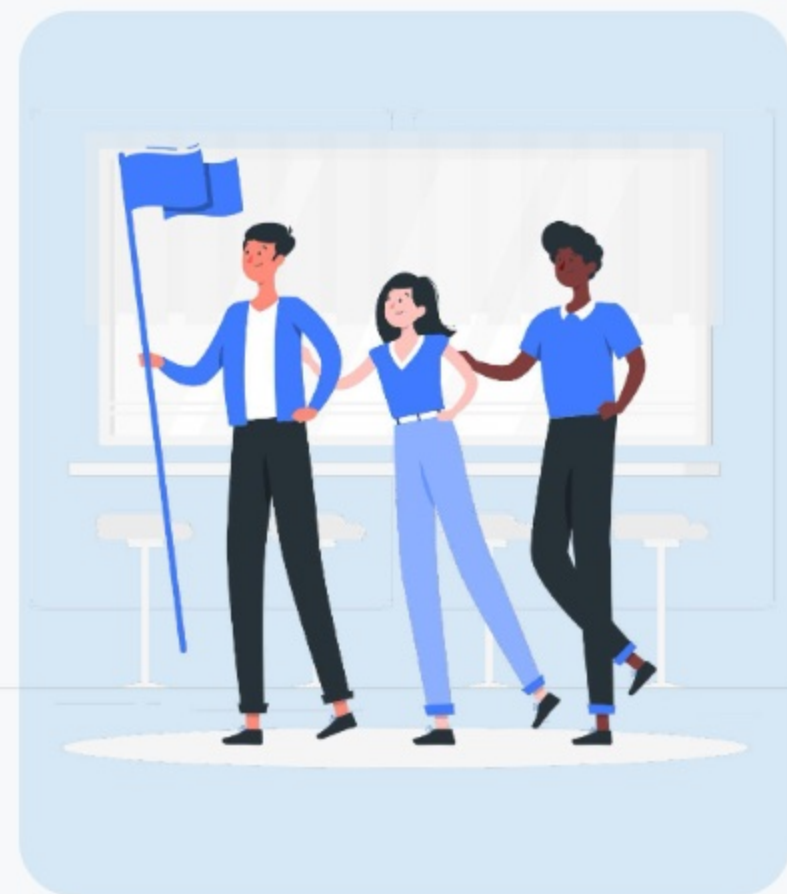


People & Roles

A Center of Excellence (CoE) involves various **roles**, each critical to its success. **Selecting the right individuals** for these roles is crucial.

◆ ADDITIONAL ROLES

Additional roles like **Subject Matter Experts**, **Salesforce Power Users**, **User Group Members**, and **Business Users** engage in specific ways, providing insights, feedback, and acting as liaisons to various committees.



Program Charter

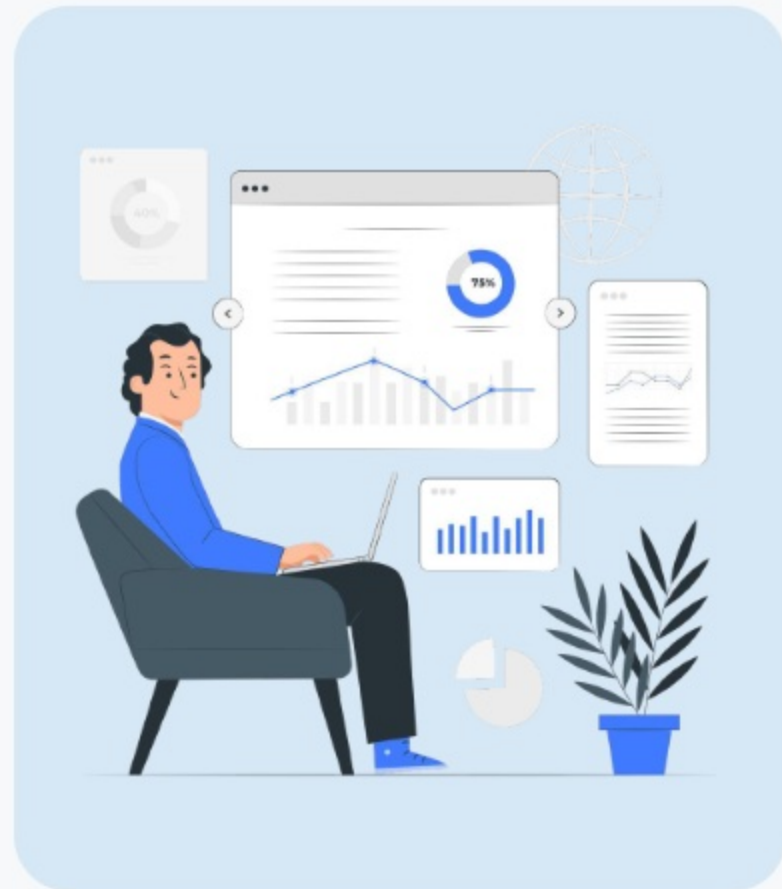
The program charter should **define and contextualize CoE roles**, including additional responsibilities related to the organization's mission.

◆ KEY MEMBERS

Key members should be **identified** before drafting the CoE charter, as they will **shape its structure and function**.

◆ DECISION-MAKING

Decision-making authority should be **clearly defined** at various **levels** (Project, Committee, Program Management/Steering Committee, Executive Sponsors) within the CoE.



Program Charter

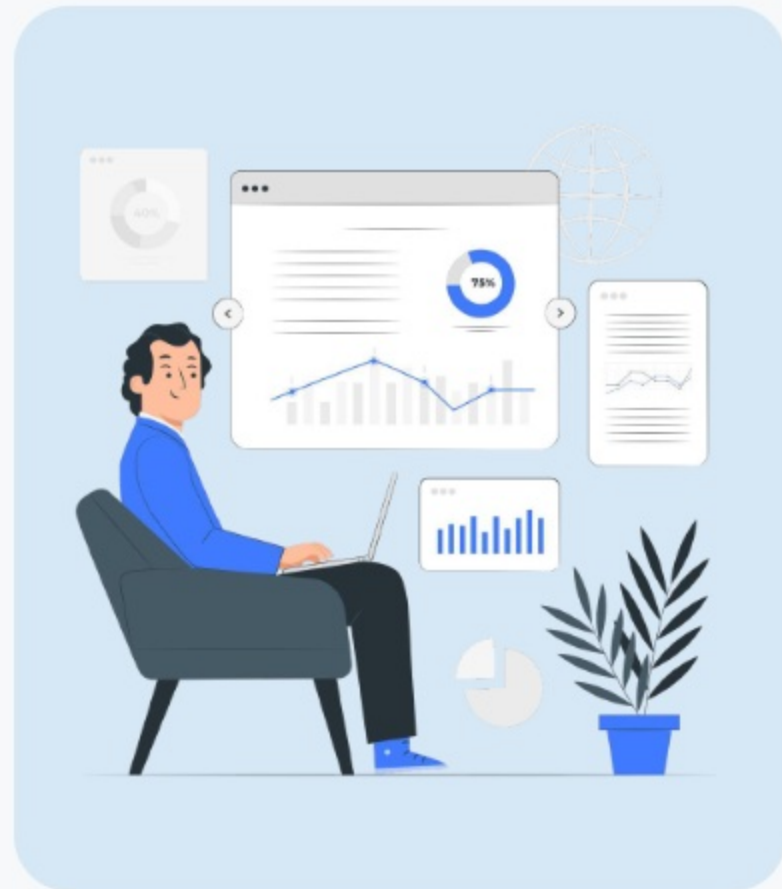
The program charter should **define and contextualize CoE roles**, including additional responsibilities related to the organization's mission.

❖ MEETING CADENCE

A **regular meeting cadence** should be established to ensure **timely decision-making** and **communication with stakeholders**.

❖ WELL-DEFINED CHARTER

A well-defined charter **guides** the CoE's work, **clarifies** complex decisions, and **justifies** resource allocation and decision-making processes.



Meetings

Regular meetings are essential for the **effectiveness of the CoE**, with their **frequency** outlined in the Program Charter.

❖ MEETING TYPES

Different types of meetings include **Program Management/Steering Committee Engagement**, **Executive Sponsor Engagement**, and **CoE Focus Areas meetings**.

❖ PROGRAM MANAGEMENT

Program Management meetings involve **key decision-makers** to ensure alignment on CoE focus areas, with **biweekly 1-hour sessions**.



Meetings

Regular meetings are essential for the **effectiveness of the CoE**, with their **frequency** outlined in the Program Charter.

❖ EXECUTIVE SPONSOR

Executive Sponsor meetings aim to update on **project status** and **address key risks or decisions**, **initially** lasting **1 hour** and then reducing to **30 minutes monthly**.

❖ FOCUS AREAS

Focus Areas meetings are conducted by **Steering Committee members** to ensure **alignment** across development workstreams, with participation depending on agenda needs.



Decisions & Other Deliverables

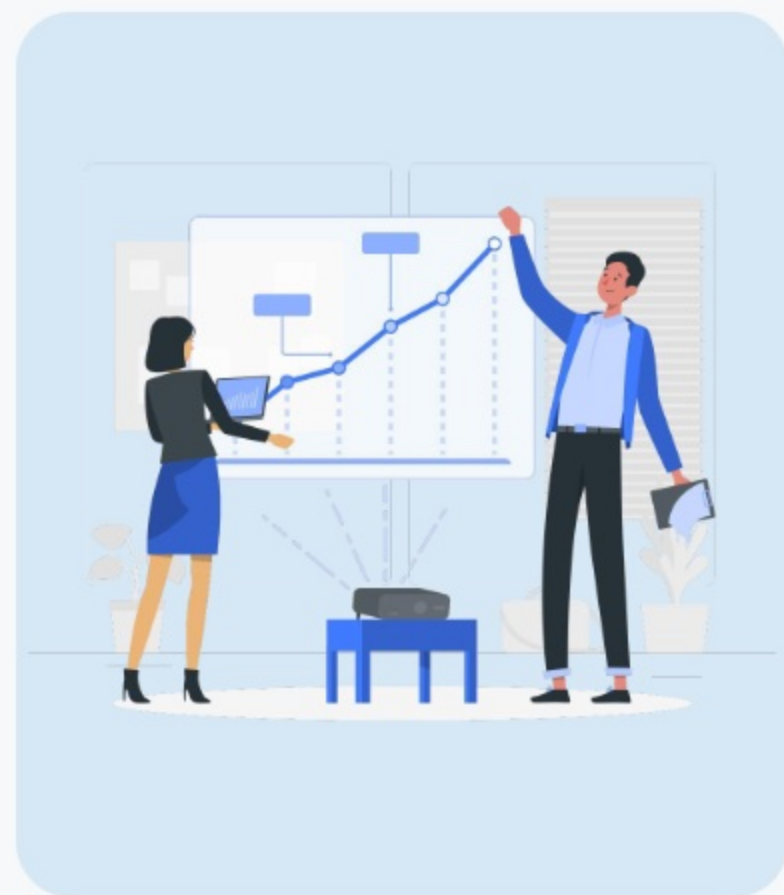
The CoE aims for **swift decision-making** to leverage Salesforce effectively towards **organizational goals**, guiding **recruitment**, **charter drafting**, and **meeting expectations**.

❖ CRUCIAL DECISIONS

A CoE facilitates crucial decisions for implementation teams' **progress**, with some decisions, like **funding or technical issues**, requiring input from Executive Sponsors or specific Focus Areas.

❖ DELIVERABLES

Beyond decisions, CoE is responsible for various deliverables such as **technical standards**, **communication plans**, and **usage policies**, with the Program Management/Steering Committee updating the Program Charter as needed.



Growth

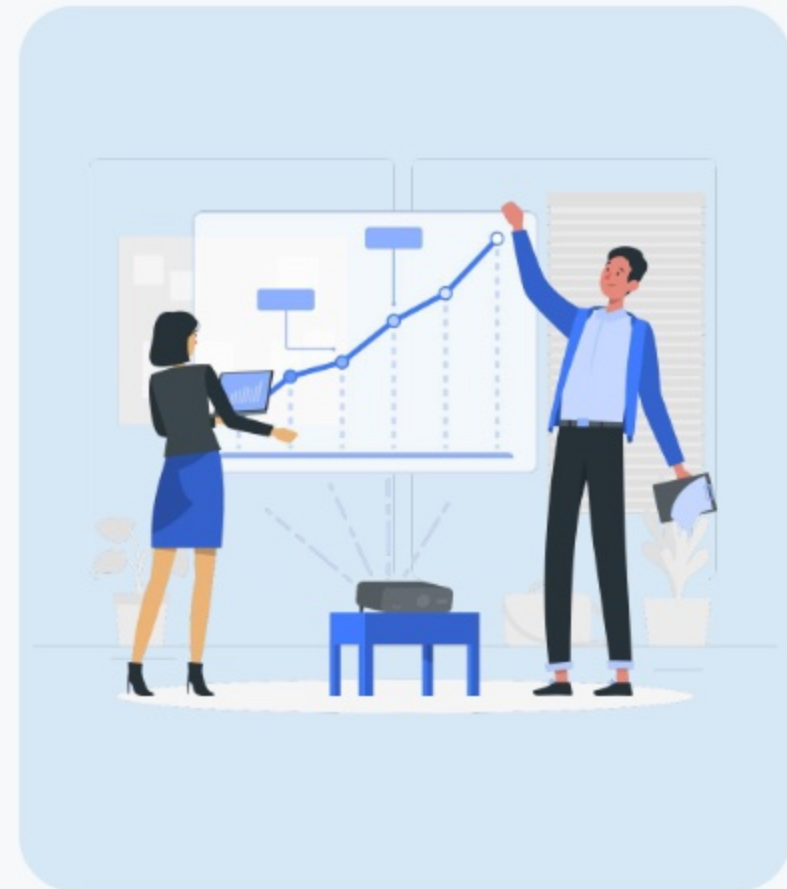
A CoE **doesn't need to be complex** initially; it can be simple first and **expanded as needed**.

❖ EARLY ESTABLISHMENT

Early establishment of a CoE allows for **better direction** of its and Salesforce's program growth.

❖ STEERING COMMITTEE

Starting with a Steering Committee focused on the **project** and the consideration of **Focus Areas** provides **long-term benefits**.



Running a Center of Excellence

To **effectively run a Center of Excellence (CoE)**, a **clear agenda** should be established for various types of **meetings**, ensuring **efficient communication** and **decision-making**.



Key elements include **logistics** planning for participant inclusivity, focusing on **program health**, updating **action items**, and **reviewing project statuses** to maintain transparency.



Discussions should primarily revolve around **addressing identified issues, requiring precise problem definition** and **prioritization**.



Recapping actions ensures **clarity on outcomes**, while fostering an environment where questions are encouraged **enhances understanding** and **engagement**.



Additionally, **facilitating continuous CoE involvement** outside meetings through collaborative tools like Chatter promotes a **transparent and open culture**.

Effective Center of Excellence

Various factors should be considered to determine whether a **Center of Excellence (CoE) is functioning effectively.**



Project progress should be **monitored**. Internal and external **roadblocks** should be **addressed** for on-time delivery.



Project success should be measured by its **adoption**, influenced by **change management** and **vision execution**.



CoE should track **budget adherence** and facilitate **decisions on budget changes**.



The aim should be for **solutions** that are **future-proof**, minimizing the need for redesigns and focusing on innovation.



AARs (After Action Reports) can be used to learn from each project stage, identifying what worked well or didn't.

Change Management

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Change Management

Change Management refers to the **process** used by an organization to **identify, prioritize, assign, execute** and **communicate changes**.

❖ TYPES OF CHANGES

In the Salesforce deployment context, a change could be **organizational**, a **business process change**, **addition or subtraction of a process**, or a **new version release** by Salesforce.

❖ EXAMPLES

An example of a big change is rolling a new business line, medium changes can be enhancements that affect a specific line of business, and small changes can be fixes, config change, reports, and templates.



Change Management Process

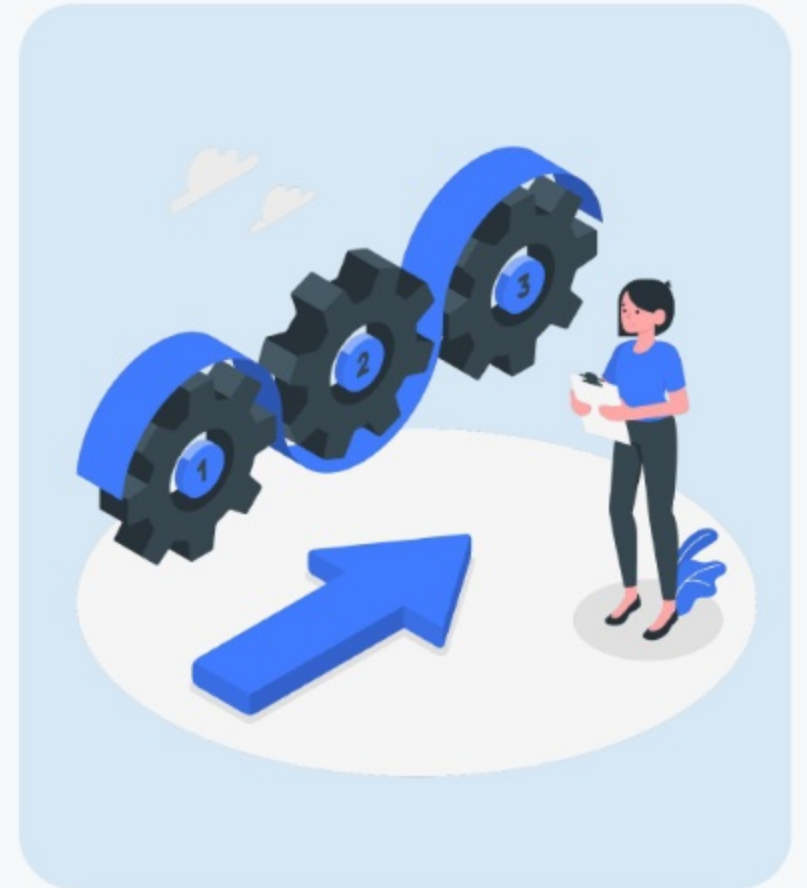
Change Management is a process of **continuous evolution** that involves **continuously analyzing the current state, collecting user feedback**, and **implementing change** when appropriate.

❖ PROCESS

Change management requires defining a **vision, strategy, and objectives**. The change management process includes these steps: **Initiate/Plan**, **Operationalize**, and **Validate**

❖ INITIATE/PLAN

In this stage, **key Salesforce capabilities** are identified, a **roadmap to implement** is developed, and capabilities are tied to **program objectives**.



Change Management Process

Change Management is a process of **continuous evolution** that involves **continuously analyzing current state, collecting user feedback**, and **implementing change** when appropriate.

❖ OPERATIONALIZE

In this phase, the application is **built, configured, and deployed**, **organizational change** is managed, and **adoption of new features** is driven.

❖ VALIDATE

In this stage, Salesforce data is **audited**, performance metrics are **monitored**, and results are used to **drive behavior** or **process change** within the organization where appropriate.



Key Users

Key users who should be involved in a change management process are the **user community**, **key decision makers**, **change control board**, and **executive sponsor**.



Customer facing personnel, management, and senior management provide feedback and influence direction.



An individual or group with proper training and understanding of the system, such as an enterprise architect, triages the feedback and requests from the field.



The Change Control Board (CCB) or Steering Committee is a cross-departmental group that meets regularly to review and approve change requests.



The Executive Sponsor is the leader of the Steering Committee who sets priorities and ensures alignment with the overall business goals.

Effective Change Management

The following **steps** can be utilized for **effective change management**:

1	An execution strategy that is as simple as possible is defined.
2	End users' input is collected, and interaction with the change management group is cultivated.
3	An executive sponsor is engaged to establish objectives, define processes, and drive adoption.
4	The level of effort, scope, and impact are determined, and processes between functional areas are identified and aligned.
5	End users' input is obtained to understand the overall impact and prioritize user requirements .

Effective Change Management

The following **steps** can be utilized for **effective change management**:

6	Implementation, end user validation, and deployment plan are defined.
7	User community is informed of changes so that they are better prepared for adoption.
8	A repeatable change management process is defined and adhered to.
9	Power users are identified to follow up on the new release and define future enhancements.

Business Scenario

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Business Scenario

Read the business scenario below and determine the most appropriate solutions for the company's requirements.



Cosmic Innovation, renowned for its smart home solutions, operates through two distinct divisions in North America and Europe, each utilizing its own Salesforce instance for operational processes. Facing challenges in change management, backlog management, design, and deployment planning due to varying governance models, the company seeks a Salesforce architect's expertise.

The architect's task is to assess the current governance structures and recommend enhancements, aiming to improve governance frameworks and lifecycle management practices used by the two divisions, streamline project delivery, and align it with the company's strategic goals for enhanced efficiency.

Requirements & Solutions

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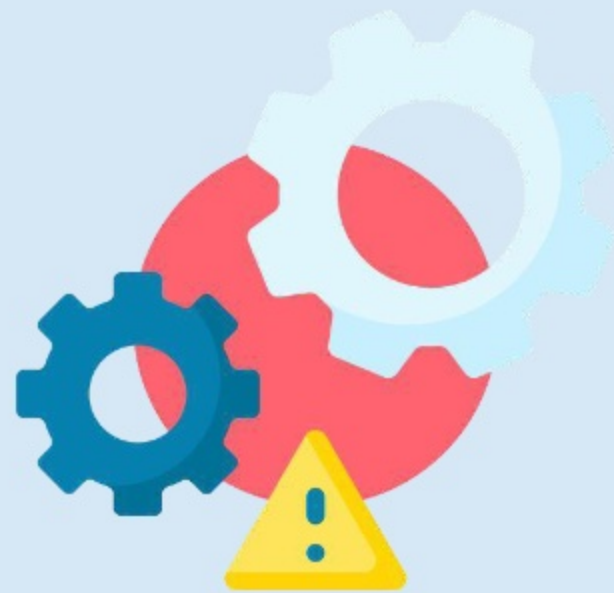


Requirement 1



SCENARIO

The North American division is grappling with certain governance challenges, leading to inefficiencies in project delivery. Recent compliance changes have necessitated a 25% budget increase for a critical project, revealing the need for a structured governance framework to manage priorities and resource allocation. The backlog is overwhelmed with low-effort yet valuable enhancements, and there are often stakeholder disagreements. In addition, upcoming major deployments lack a cohesive strategy to ensure smooth transitions to live environments.



Solution 1



SOLUTION

The formation of a **Center of Excellence**, including **Executive Sponsors** and the **Program Team**, would standardize governance, enhance project alignment, and streamline delivery processes. A **Change Control Board** should authorize the additional budget and oversee any other change requests. To address backlog and stakeholder disagreements, facilitating the creation of a **prioritization model** with **stakeholders** is crucial. A **citizen development program** would address low-effort backlog items efficiently. For deployment readiness, all changes must be in **source control**, and the deployment package must be validated against production.



Solution 1



Center of
Excellence



Change
Control Board



Prioritization
Model



Citizen
Development
Program



Source
Control

Requirement 2



SCENARIO

The company's European division is confronting unique challenges in integrating multiple new projects within their Salesforce Org. There's a need to manage and prioritize a backlog of new feature requests that align with their strategic objectives. Additionally, the division faces design conflicts among project teams and the necessity to implement new custom Salesforce objects and enhanced security measures like SAML for Single Sign-On. Effective documentation and governance of these processes are also critical concerns.

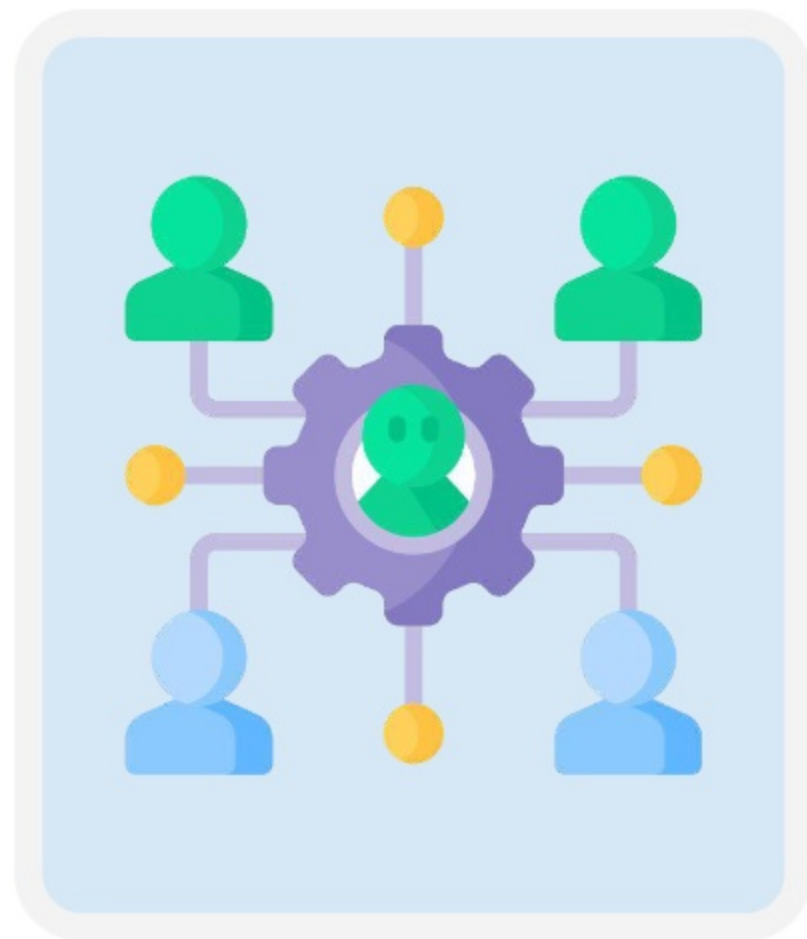


Solution 2 (Part 1)



SOLUTION

Establishing a **Center of Excellence (CoE)** focused European operations is essential. This CoE should create a **charter document** to streamline new project integrations within their Salesforce Org. It should also use a **project management tool** for **backlog prioritization**, addressing the influx of new feature requests. To prevent design conflicts, the CoE should develop **design standards** that all project teams must adhere to. Involving an **Architecture Review Board** would be beneficial for making technical decisions like implementing new custom objects and SAML for Single Sign-On.

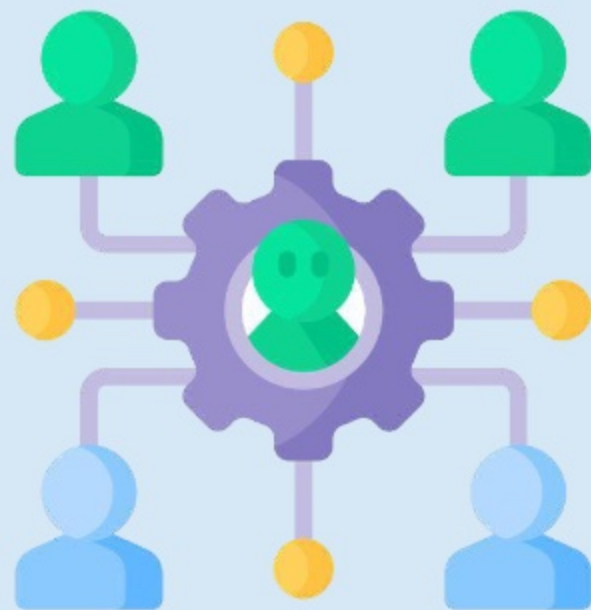


Solution 2 (Part 2)



SOLUTION

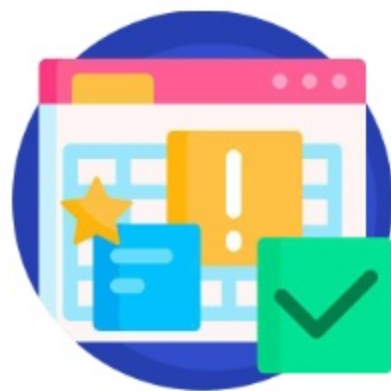
Additionally, robust documentation practices, including a **documentation repository**, **change control log**, and effective **requirements management**, should be integral components of the governance framework to ensure clear communication and alignment of all projects with the division's strategic goals.



Solution 2 (Part 3)



Center of
Excellence



Project
Management
Tool



Design
Standards



Project
Charter



Architecture
Review Board

Learn More

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- [!\[\]\(b71552d33dbf62adf5e5199a70ee02bf_img.jpg\) Managing Governance with a Center of Excellence](#)
- [!\[\]\(03134b765d1473836ff001925b1b0550_img.jpg\) What is Change Management?](#)
- [!\[\]\(aed6947356668967079310026052edc0_img.jpg\) Change and Release Management](#)
- [!\[\]\(e61aeb0d9066d5d9e54d9b655f50da3d_img.jpg\) Governance Trailmix](#)

